

Gemini.google.com	1
Study Courses	2
Embassy Appointment	2
Applying for a Study Visa.....	2
Steps to Apply.....	2
What documents are needed	2
How long it usually takes	3
Documents Needed	3
Money Requirements	3
Residence Permit.....	3
Working While Studying.....	4
Renewing the Residence Permit	4
Changing to a Work Permit.....	4
Official Information	4
Application Forms.....	5
Tips for Students	5
Claude.ai.....	5
1. Study Courses.....	6
2. Embassy Appointment	6
3. Applying for a Study Visa	6
Where to apply:	6
Documents needed:	7
How to apply:	7
How long it takes:	7
4. Documents Needed.....	7
5. Money Requirements	8
6. Residence Permit	8
7. Working While Studying.....	8
8. Renewing the Residence Permit.....	9
9. Changing to a Work Permit	9
10. Official Information.....	9
11. Application Forms	10

12. Tips for Students.....	10
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Study Courses

The following types of study and training programs allow non-EU students to apply for a National Visa (D) or a Temporary Residence Permit for the purpose of study in Slovakia:

- Full-time higher education programs at accredited universities (Bachelor's, Master's, and Doctoral levels).
- Language and preparatory courses for university studies organized by an accredited higher education institution.
- Secondary school studies (student exchange programs or regular enrollment).
- Specialized training and educational activities at state-recognized institutions.

Embassy Appointment

Booking an appointment for a visa or residence permit application is mandatory:

- The primary method is through the Electronic Appointment System (EZOV) on the official website of the Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs of the Slovak Republic.
- In some jurisdictions, applicants may need to email the specific Slovak Embassy or Consulate directly or use a designated external service provider if the embassy has an agreement with one (e.g., BLS International).
- Appointments should be booked well in advance, as slots are often limited during the peak periods of July and August.

Applying for a Study Visa

The process for a study visa (National Visa D) or Temporary Residence is as follows:

Steps to Apply

- Secure admission to a Slovak educational institution.
- Gather all required original documents and their official translations.
- Book an appointment at the Slovak Embassy or Consulate in your country of residence.
- Submit the application in person and undergo a brief interview.
- Wait for the decision and collect the visa/permit.

What documents are needed

- Completed application form.
- Valid passport.
- Color photographs.

- Official letter of acceptance from the school/university.
- Proof of financial means.
- Criminal record certificate (apostilled/legalized).
- Proof of accommodation in Slovakia.

How long it usually takes

- National Visa (D): Decisions are typically made within 30 days.
- Temporary Residence for study: The legal timeframe for a decision is 30 days after the complete application is received.

Documents Needed

Applicants must prepare the following documentation (all foreign documents must be apostilled or legalized and translated into Slovak by an official Slovak translator):

- Official application form for the National Visa or Temporary Residence.
- Two recent color photographs (3 x 3.5 cm).
- Passport valid for at least 3 months beyond the intended stay.
- Proof of Purpose: Acceptance letter from the university or school in Slovakia.
- Proof of Funds: Personal bank statement showing sufficient balance.
- Proof of Clean Criminal Record: An extract from the criminal record from the country of origin and any country where the applicant lived for more than 90 days in the last 3 years.
- Proof of Accommodation: A lease agreement, a deed of ownership, or a confirmation from a student dormitory.
- Proof of Health Insurance: Travel medical insurance (minimum €30,000 coverage) or proof of health insurance in Slovakia.

Money Requirements

Non-EU students must prove they have the financial resources to cover their living costs:

- The requirement is calculated based on the subsistence minimum in Slovakia.
- For the 2024/2025 period, the subsistence minimum is approximately €273.99 per month.
- A student applying for a one-year residence permit generally needs to prove they have at least 12 times this amount (approximately €3,288) in a bank account.
- Proof is usually provided via a bank statement in the applicant's name.

Residence Permit

After arriving in Slovakia on a National Visa (D) or if applying directly for residence:

- Within 3 working days of arrival, the student must report their residence to the Foreign Police (Cudzinecká polícia).
- If the residence permit was not already granted at the embassy, the student must submit the application at the Foreign Police department responsible for their place of residence.
- The student must undergo a medical examination at a specialized clinic in Slovakia within 30 days of receiving the residence permit card to prove they do not suffer from a disease threatening public health.

Working While Studying

International students from non-EU countries are permitted to work:

- Students at the university level can work up to 20 hours per week.
- During university holidays (summer and winter breaks), students may work full-time.
- Secondary school students can work up to 10 hours per week.
- Work is usually performed under a "Contract on student part-time work" (Dohoda o brigádnickej práci študentov).

Renewing the Residence Permit

If the study program lasts longer than the initial permit:

- The student must apply for a renewal at the Foreign Police.
- The application for renewal must be submitted no later than the last day of the current permit's validity.
- Requirements include an updated confirmation of enrollment, proof of funds for the next period, and proof of continued accommodation and insurance.

Changing to a Work Permit

After graduating from a Slovak university:

- Graduates can apply for a renewal of their temporary residence for 9 months for the purpose of seeking employment or starting a business.
- Once a job is secured, the student applies for a "Temporary Residence for the purpose of employment."
- Graduates of Slovak universities have a simplified process: the employer does not need to perform a labor market test (reporting the vacancy for 15-20 days) to hire them.

Official Information

Official and legal information can be found at the following governmental websites:

- Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs of the Slovak Republic: mzv.sk
- Ministry of Interior of the Slovak Republic (Foreign Police information): minv.sk
- IOM Migration Information Centre (Official partner for foreigners): mic.iom.sk
- Slovak Academic Information Agency (SAIA): saia.sk

Application Forms

Official forms are available for download here:

- Application for National Visa: Found on the Ministry of Foreign Affairs website under the "Consular Services" section.
- Application for Temporary Residence: Found on the Ministry of Interior website under the "Foreign Police" documents section.

Tips for Students

To ensure a successful application, students should avoid these common mistakes:

- Invalid Translations: All documents must be translated by a certified Slovak translator. Translations from home countries not performed by a Slovak-registered translator are often rejected.
- Missing Legalization: Ensure that criminal record checks and diplomas have the correct Apostille or Super-legalization from the issuing country's authorities.
- Inadequate Bank Statements: The bank statement must be in the student's name (or a parent's name with a notarized affidavit of support) and must show a sufficient balance that meets the latest subsistence minimum.
- Expired Dates: The criminal record certificate must not be older than 90 days at the time the application is submitted.
- Incorrect Photos: Use the exact dimensions (3 x 3.5 cm) required by Slovak regulations, as standard passport sizes from other countries may differ.

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1. Study Courses

Non-EU students can apply for temporary residence for the purpose of study if enrolled in one of the following:

- Full-time secondary school study (applicant must be under 20 at time of application)
- Post-secondary, graduate, specialisation, or higher vocational study (applicant must be under 23)
- Full-time university study (bachelor's, master's, or PhD level)
- A language or professional training course for university studies, when this course is organised and carried out by a Slovak university

Part-time study generally does not qualify for this type of residence permit.

Source: Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs (mzv.sk) and European Commission Immigration Portal

2. Embassy Appointment

- Appointments are usually booked directly through the Slovak embassy or consulate responsible for the student's country of residence, normally by email or through the embassy's online booking system (where available)
- Some embassies use the central electronic visa system at ezov.mzv.sk for Schengen visas; for national (type D) visas and residence applications, students should check the specific embassy's website for its booking method
- It is recommended to book several months in advance, since embassies often have long waiting times and limited appointment slots
- Students should bring all required documents in their original form (plus translations) to the appointment, as incomplete applications will not be accepted

Source: Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs (mzv.sk) — embassy-specific consular service pages

3. Applying for a Study Visa

Who needs it: Non-EU/EEA students staying in Slovakia longer than 90 days must apply for temporary residence for the purpose of study (not a "visa" in the short-stay sense, but a long-term residence permit).

Where to apply:

- At the Slovak embassy or consulate in the student's home country (most common route), or

- Directly at a Foreign Police Department in Slovakia, if the student is already legally present in the country on another basis

Documents needed:

- Completed application form for temporary residence
- Valid passport
- 2 recent passport-style photographs (3 x 3.5 cm)
- Confirmation of studies from the host institution or relevant ministry (translated into Slovak)
- Proof of sufficient financial resources (translated into Slovak)
- Criminal record extract from the country of origin and from any country of residence of more than 90 days in the last 3 years (apostilled or superlegalised); high school students are exempt
- Documents proving the purpose of stay, financial means, and criminal record cannot be older than 90 days at submission

How to apply:

1. Secure admission/acceptance to a Slovak educational institution
2. Gather and translate required documents
3. Book an appointment and submit the application at the embassy/consulate (or Foreign Police if applying from inside Slovakia)
4. Attend an interview at the embassy, if applicable
5. Wait for the decision
6. Travel to Slovakia within 180 days of the decision
7. Report to the Foreign Police within 3 working days of arrival
8. Collect the residence card and submit a medical certificate within 30 days

How long it takes:

- The Foreign Police must decide within 30 days of receiving a complete application
- Residence card issuance: 30 days standard, or 2 working days for an expedited fee

Source: SAIA Research/Study in Slovakia (funded by the Ministry of Education) and mzv.sk

4. Documents Needed

- Valid passport (valid at least 90 days beyond the intended departure date)
- Completed temporary residence application form
- 2 passport photographs (3 x 3.5 cm, ICAO standard)

- Confirmation of studies / acceptance letter from the institution, translated into Slovak
- Proof of sufficient financial means, translated into Slovak
- Criminal record extract (apostilled/superlegalised), if applicable
- Proof of accommodation (not required for students enrolled at a Slovak higher education institution)
- Health insurance documentation (required after arrival, within the first 30 days)

All foreign-language documents (except Czech) must be translated into Slovak by an officially certified translator.

Source: SAIA Research in Slovakia, mzv.sk

5. Money Requirements

- Students must show proof of sufficient financial means for their stay
- A commonly cited general benchmark used in visa assessments is around EUR 56 per day of stay; for residence permit purposes specifically, embassies and the Foreign Police assess sufficiency case by case, often referencing the minimum subsistence amount set under Slovak law
- Acceptable proof includes: a bank account statement, a scholarship award letter, a financial coverage confirmation, or an affidavit from another person agreeing to cover costs, accompanied by that person's bank statement
- This document cannot be older than 90 days at the time of application

Source: mzv.sk (Supporting Documents, National Visa pages)

Note: exact minimum amounts can vary by embassy and case; students should confirm the current required sum directly with the embassy handling their application.

6. Residence Permit

After arriving in Slovakia, a student must:

1. Report their stay to the Foreign Police Department within 3 working days of entry (if not already granted residence)
2. If the residence permit was approved abroad, collect the residence card from the Foreign Police Department in Slovakia (in person, or via a person holding power of attorney)
3. Submit a medical certificate confirming no public-health risk, within 30 days of collecting the card; this certificate must come from a specified medical centre and cannot be older than 30 days
4. Submit proof of health insurance within 30 days of collecting the residence card

Source: SAIA Research in Slovakia, Ministry of Interior (minv.sk)

7. Working While Studying

Yes. Third-country nationals holding temporary residence for the purpose of study can:

- Work up to 80 hours per month for university students, without needing a separate work permit or change of residence purpose
- Work under an employment contract or under agreements performed outside an employment relationship (e.g., work performance agreement)
- Start a business without changing the purpose of their residence permit

Source: SAIA Study in Slovakia, Ministry of Interior, Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs and Family (employment.gov.sk)

8. Renewing the Residence Permit

If a course lasts longer than the granted residence period, or the student needs to extend their stay:

- The application for renewal must be submitted in person at the competent Foreign Police Department, or electronically, no later than the last day of validity of the current temporary residence
- Required documents typically include: completed renewal application form, valid passport, confirmation of continued enrollment from the institution, proof of accommodation, and proof of sufficient financial resources
- Temporary residence for study can be granted for the expected duration of the course, up to a maximum of 6 years, so renewal is generally only needed if the original grant did not cover the full study period or the residence card itself has a shorter validity than the permit

Source: Ministry of Interior (minv.sk), SAIA Research in Slovakia

9. Changing to a Work Permit

Yes, this is possible under specific conditions:

- A student who successfully completes their studies (final/graduation exam at secondary school, or first, second, or third level university education) may apply to the Foreign Police to change the purpose of their residence
- Graduates of full-degree studies in Slovakia can apply for renewal of their temporary residence for the purpose of job-seeking or starting a business; this can be granted for up to 9 months
- For this renewal, a university diploma or confirmation of completed studies must be submitted; proof of health insurance, a new medical certificate, and a criminal record extract are not required for this specific application

- Once employed, graduates with a Slovak degree generally have free access to the labour market and do not need an additional work permit beyond valid residence, though this should be confirmed for the individual's specific situation
- A temporary residence permit for study also remains valid for up to 30 days after completing studies for the purpose of job-searching

Source: SAIA Research in Slovakia, SAIA Study in Slovakia

10. Official Information

- Ministry of Foreign and European Affairs of the Slovak Republic: mzv.sk
- Ministry of Interior of the Slovak Republic (Foreign Police / residence matters): minv.sk
- Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs and Family (employment information for foreigners): employment.gov.sk
- IOM Migration Information Centre Slovakia (practical guidance, supported by the Slovak government): mic.iom.sk
- SAIA (Slovak Academic Information Agency), Study in Slovakia / Research in Slovakia portals, funded by the Ministry of Education: studyinslovakia.saia.sk and researchinslovakia.saia.sk
- European Commission EU Immigration Portal, Slovakia section: home-affairs.ec.europa.eu

11. Application Forms

- Official temporary residence application forms and renewal forms are published by the Ministry of Interior and made available through the IOM Migration Information Centre's forms page: mic.iom.sk (Download → Forms → Residence)
- The official electronic application form can also be accessed through the Foreign Police's online Booking system when applying directly in Slovakia
- The National Visa application form (PDF) is available on the relevant Slovak embassy's website under "Visa and Services"

Students should always download forms from the official embassy or ministry website relevant to their case, since forms can be updated and version mismatches may cause delays.

12. Tips for Students

Common mistakes and how to avoid them:

- **Applying too late.** Embassy appointments and the 30-day decision period mean the process should start several months before the intended start of studies.

- **Submitting outdated documents.** Financial proof, criminal record extracts, and confirmation of studies must not be older than 90 days at submission; students should time document collection accordingly.
- **Missing translations.** Any document not in Slovak (except Czech) must be translated by an officially certified translator; uncertified translations are often rejected.
- **Incomplete financial proof.** Vague or insufficient bank statements are a frequent cause of delay; students should check the specific sum and document format requested by their embassy.
- **Missing the post-arrival deadlines.** Reporting to the Foreign Police within 3 working days of arrival, and submitting the medical certificate and health insurance proof within 30 days of receiving the residence card, are easy to overlook but are mandatory.
- **Assuming all courses qualify.** Only full-time study at a recognised institution, within the relevant age categories, qualifies for a study-purpose residence permit; part-time or unrecognised programmes may not.
- **Not planning the renewal or purpose-change application early.** Applications to renew residence, or to switch to a job-seeking/work purpose after graduation, should be filed before the current permit expires.

Source: Compiled from SAIA Research in Slovakia, mzv.sk, and minv.sk guidance